

Bhagavad Gita - Chapter 4

Lectures by Swami Sarvapriyananda

043. Chapter 4 Verses 1-3

VERSE 4.1

श्रीभगवानुवाच ।
इमं विवस्वते योगं प्रोक्तवानहमव्ययम् ।
विवस्वान्मनवे प्राह मनुरिक्ष्वाकवेऽब्रवीत् ॥ १ ॥

śrībhagavānuvāca |
imaṃ vivasvate yogaṃ
proktavānahamavyayam |
vivasvānmanave prāha
manurikṣvākave'bravīt ||

◆ śrī-bhagavān uvāca – The Blessed Lord said; ◆ imam – this; vivasvate – to Vivasvan (the Sun-god); yogaṃ – Yoga; ◆ proktavān – taught; aham – I; avyayam – imperishable; ◆ vivasvān – Vivasvan; manave – to Manu; prāha – taught; ◆ manuḥ – Manu; ikṣvākave – to Ikshvaku; abravīt – taught.

The Blessed Lord said: This imperishable Yoga of action (and the wisdom arising from it) I taught to Vivasvan (the Sun) at the beginning of creation. Vivasvan taught it to his son Manu, and Manu to his son Ikshvaku.

VERSE 4.2

एवं परम्पराप्राप्तमिमं राजर्षयो विदुः ।
स कालेनेह महता योगो नष्टः परन्तप ॥ २ ॥

evam paramparāprāptam
imam rājarṣayo viduḥ |
sa kāleneha mahatā
yogo naṣṭaḥ parantapa ||

◆ evam – thus; paramparā-prāptam – received through tradition/lineage; ◆
imam – this; rāja-rṣayaḥ – the royal sages; viduḥ – knew; ◆ saḥ – that; kālena –
by time; iha – here/in this world; mahatā – long; ◆ yogaḥ – Yoga; naṣṭaḥ – lost;
parantapa – O scorcher of foes.

**O Arjuna! The royal sages know this (yoga) which was
handed down in regular succession from generation to
generation. But by long lapse of time, this Yoga was lost to
the world.**

VERSE 4.3

स एवायं मया तेऽद्य योगः प्रोक्तः पुरातनः ।
भक्तोऽसि मे सखा चेति रहस्यं ह्येतदुत्तमम् ॥ ३ ॥

sa evāyaṁ mayā te'dya
yogaḥ proktaḥ purātanaḥ |
bhakto'si me sakhā ceti
rahasyaṁ hyetaduttamam ||

◆ saḥ – that; eva – same; ayam – this; mayā – by Me; te – to you; adya – today; ◆
yogaḥ – Yoga; proktaḥ – has been told; purātanaḥ – ancient; ◆ bhaktaḥ –
devotee; asi – you are; me – My; sakhā – friend; ca – and; iti – thus; ◆ rahasyam –
secret; hi – indeed; etat – this; uttamam – supreme.

**This same ancient Yoga has now been taught by Me, for you
are My devotee and friend. It is indeed the supreme secret.**

044. Chapter 4 Verses 4-6

VERSE 4.4

अर्जुन उवाच ।
अपरं भवतो जन्म परं जन्म विवस्वतः ।
कथमेतद्विजानीयां त्वमादौ प्रोक्तवानिति ॥ ४ ॥

arjuna uvāca |
aparaṁ bhavato janma
paraṁ janma vivasvataḥ |
kathametadvijānīyāṁ
tvamādaḥ proktavāniti ||

◆ arjunaḥ uvāca – Arjuna said; ◆ aparaṁ – later; bhavataḥ – Your; janma – birth; ◆ paraṁ – prior/ancient; janma – birth; vivasvataḥ – of Vivasvan; ◆ katham – how; etat – this; vijānīyāṁ – should I understand; ◆ tvam – You; ādaḥ – in the beginning; proktavān – taught; iti – thus.

Arjuna said: Later was your birth, earlier the birth of Vivasvan (Sun); how then am I to understand that you taught it to him in the beginning?

VERSE 4.5

श्रीभगवानुवाच ।
बहूनि मे व्यतीतानि जन्मानि तव चार्जुन ।
तान्यहं वेद सर्वाणि न त्वं वेत्थ परन्तप ॥ 5 ॥*

śrībhagavānuvāca |
bahūni me vyatītāni
janmāni tava cārjuna |
tānyaham veda sarvāṇi
na tvam vettha parantapa ||

◆ śrī-bhagavān uvāca – The Blessed Lord said; ◆ bahūni – many; me – My; vyatītāni – have passed; ◆ janmāni – births; tava – your; ca – and; arjuna – O Arjuna; ◆ tāni – them; aham – I; veda – know; sarvāṇi – all; ◆ na – not; tvam – you; vettha – know; parantapa – O scorcher of foes.

The Lord said: O Arjuna! Many births of Mine have passed as well as yours. I know them all but you know them not.

VERSE 4.6

अजोऽपि सन्नव्ययात्मा भूतानामीश्वरोऽपि सन् ।
प्रकृतिं स्वामधिष्ठाय सम्भवाम्यात्ममायया ॥ ६ ॥

ajo'pi sannavyayātmā
bhūtānāmīśvaro'pi san |
prakṛtiṃ svāmadhiṣṭhāya
sambhavāmyātmamāyayā ||

◆ ajaḥ – unborn; api – although; san – being; avyaya-ātmā – imperishable Self;
◆ bhūtānām – of beings; īśvaraḥ – the Lord; api – although; san – being; ◆
prakṛtim – nature; svām – My own; adhiṣṭhāya – presiding over/governing; ◆
sambhavāmi – I manifest/come into being; ātma-māyayā – by My own Maya
(creative power).

**Though unborn and eternal in My being, the Lord and
controller of all beings, controlling My own nature, I come
into being by the power of My Maya-Sakti.**

045. Chapter 4 Verses 7-8

VERSE 4.7

यदा यदा हि धर्मस्य ग्लानिर्भवति भारत ।
अभ्युत्थानमधर्मस्य तदात्मानं सृजाम्यहम् ॥ ७ ॥

yadā yadā hi dharmasya
glānirbhavati bhārata |
abhyutthānamadharmasya
tadātmānaṃ sṛjāmyaham ||

◆ yadā yadā – whenever; hi – indeed; dharmasya – of righteousness (Dharma);
◆ glāniḥ – decline; bhavati – occurs; bhārata – O Bharata; ◆ abhyutthānam –
rise; adharmasya – of unrighteousness; ◆ tadā – then; ātmānam – Myself; sṛjāmi
– manifest/create; aham – I.

**O Arjuna! Whenever there is a decline of righteousness and
rise of evil, I manifest Myself.**

VERSE 4.8

परित्त्राणाय साधूनां विनाशाय च दुष्कृताम् ।
धर्मसंस्थापनार्थाय सम्भवामि युगे युगे ॥ ४ ॥

paritrāṇāya sādḥūnām
vināśāya ca duṣkṛtām |
dharma-saṁsthāpanārthāya
sambhavāmi yuge yuge ||

◆ paritrāṇāya – for the protection; sādḥūnām – of the good; ◆ vināśāya – for the destruction; ca – and; duṣkṛtām – of the wicked; ◆ dharma-saṁsthāpana-arthāya – for the sake of establishing righteousness; ◆ sambhavāmi – I am born; yuge yuge – from age to age.

For the protection of the good, for the destruction of the wicked, and for establishing Dharma, I take birth in every age.

046. Chapter 4 Verses 9-10

VERSE 4.9

जन्म कर्म च मे दिव्यमेवं यो वेत्ति तत्त्वतः ।
त्यक्त्वा देहं पुनर्जन्म नैति मामेति सोऽर्जुन ॥ ९ ॥

janma karma ca me divyam
evam yo vetti tattvataḥ |
tyaktvā dehaṁ punarjanma
naiti māmēti so'rjuna ||

◆ janma – birth; karma – action; ca – and; me – My; divyam – divine; ◆ evam – thus; yaḥ – who; vetti – knows; tattvataḥ – in truth; ◆ tyaktvā – having abandoned; deham – the body; punaḥ-janma – rebirth; ◆ na eti – does not attain; mām – to Me; eti – comes; saḥ – he; arjuna – O Arjuna.

Those who understand the divine nature of My birth and activities, O Arjun, upon leaving the body, do not have to take birth again, but come to My eternal abode.

VERSE 4.10

वीतरागभयक्रोधा मन्मया मामुपाश्रिताः ।
बहवो ज्ञानतपसा पूता मद्भावमागताः ॥ 10 ॥

vītarāgabhayakrodhā
manmayā māmupāśritāḥ |
bahavo jñānatapasā
pūtā madbhāvamāgatāḥ ||

◆ vīta-rāga-bhaya-krodhāḥ – free from attachment, fear, and anger; ◆ man-mayāḥ – absorbed in Me; mām – in Me; upāśritāḥ – taking refuge; ◆ bahavaḥ – many; jñāna-tapasā – by the penance of knowledge; ◆ pūtāḥ – purified; mad-bhāvam – My being; āgatāḥ – have attained.

**Free from desire, fear, and hatred, absorbed in Me, taking
refuge in Me, many purified by the penance of knowledge
have attained Me.**

047. Chapter 4 Verses 11-13

VERSE 4.11

ये यथा मां प्रपद्यन्ते तांस्तथैव भजाम्यहम् ।
मम वर्त्मानुवर्तन्ते मनुष्याः पार्थ सर्वशः ॥ 11 ॥

ye yathā mām prapadyante
tāmstathaiva bhajāmyaham |
mama vartmānuvarta nte
manuṣyāḥ pārtha sarvaśaḥ ||

◆ ye – who; yathā – in whatever way; mām – Me; prapadyante – surrender/
approach; ◆ tān – them; tathā eva – in that very way; bhajāmi – reward/
reciprocate; aham – I; ◆ mama – My; vartma – path; anuvartante – follow; ◆
manuṣyāḥ – men; pārtha – O Partha; sarvaśaḥ – in every way.

**O Arjuna! In whatsoever form one seeks Me, I reach him in
that form, for all mankind are but following the paths I laid
down for them.**

VERSE 4.12

काङ्क्षन्तः कर्मणां सिद्धिं यजन्त इह देवताः ।
क्षिप्रं हि मानुषे लोके सिद्धिर्भवति कर्मजा ॥ 12 ॥

kāṅkṣantaḥ karmaṇām siddhiṃ
yajanta iha devatāḥ |
kṣipram hi mānuṣe loke
siddhirbhavati karmajā ||

◆ kāṅkṣantaḥ – longing for; karmaṇām – of actions; siddhiṃ – success/fruit; ◆
yajante – worship; iha – in this world; devatāḥ – the gods; ◆ kṣipram – quickly;
hi – indeed; mānuṣe loke – in the world of men; ◆ siddhiḥ – success; bhavati – is
attained; karma-jā – born of action.

**Longing for success in action, in this world, (men) worship
the deities. For success is quickly attained through action in
this world of Man.**

VERSE 4.13

चातुर्वर्ण्यं मया सृष्टं गुणकर्मविभागशः ।
तस्य कर्तारमपि मां विद्वद्यकर्तारमव्ययम् ॥ 13 ॥

cāturvarṇyaṃ mayā sṛṣṭaṃ
guṇakarmavibhāgaśaḥ |
tasya kartāramapi mām
viddhyakartāramavyayam ||

◆ cātur-varṇyam – the four-fold order (Varnas); mayā – by Me; sṛṣṭam – was created; ◆ guṇa-karma-vibhāgaśaḥ – according to the distribution of qualities and actions; ◆ tasya – of that; kartāram – the author; api – although; mām – Me; ◆ viddhi – know; akartāram – the non-doer; avyayam – immutable/unchanging.

The four castes were created by Me according to the division of gunas and karma. Though I am their Creator, yet know that I neither act nor change.

048. Chapter 4 Verses 14-17

VERSE 4.14

न मां कर्माणि लिम्पन्ति न मे कर्मफले स्पृहा ।
इति मां योऽभिजानाति कर्मभिर्न स बध्यते ॥ 14 ॥

na māṃ karmāṇi limpanti
na me karmaphale sprhā |
iti māṃ yo'bhijānāti
karmabhirna sa badhyate ||

◆ na – not; māṃ – Me; karmāṇi – actions; limpanti – taint/stain; ◆ na – not; me – for Me; karma-phale – in the fruit of action; sprhā – desire; ◆ iti – thus; māṃ – Me; yaḥ – who; abhijānāti – knows; ◆ karmabhiḥ – by actions; na – not; saḥ – he; badhyate – is bound.

Actions do not taint Me, nor have I desire for the fruit of actions; He who knows Me thus is not bound by karma.

VERSE 4.15

एवं ज्ञात्वा कृतं कर्म पूर्वैरपि मुमुक्षुभिः ।
कुरु कर्मैव तस्मात्त्वं पूर्वैः पूर्वतरं कृतम् ॥ 15 ॥

evam jñātvā kṛtaṁ karma
pūrvairapi mumukṣubhiḥ |
kuru karmaiva tasmāttvaṁ
pūrvaiḥ pūrvataraṁ kṛtaṁ ||

◆ evam – thus; jñātvā – knowing; kṛtaṁ – was performed; karma – action; ◆
pūrvaiḥ – by the ancients; api – also; mumukṣubhiḥ – seekers of liberation; ◆
kuru – perform; karma – action; eva – only; tasmāt – therefore; tvam – you; ◆
pūrvaiḥ – by the ancients; pūrvataram – in olden times; kṛtaṁ – performed.

Thus knowing, the ancient spiritual aspirants performed the action. Therefore you shall do the same (desireless) action as performed by the ancients in older times.

VERSE 4.16

किं कर्म किमकर्मेति कवयोऽप्यत्र मोहिताः ।
तत्ते कर्म प्रवक्ष्यामि यज्ज्ञात्वा मोक्षयसेऽशुभात् ॥ 16 ॥

kiṃ karma kimakarmeti
kavayo'pyatra mohitāḥ |
tatte karma pravakṣyāmi
yajjñātvā mokṣyase'subhāt ||

◆ kim – what; karma – action; kim – what; akarma – inaction; iti – thus; ◆
kavayaḥ – the wise/poets; api – even; atra – in this; mohitāḥ – are deluded; ◆ tat
– that; te – to you; karma – action; pravakṣyāmi – I shall explain; ◆ yat – which;
jñātvā – knowing; mokṣyase – you will be liberated; aśubhāt – from evil/
bondage.

**What is action, and what is not action? In this matter, even
the wise are deluded. I will teach you that action knowing
which you shall be liberated from evil.**

VERSE 4.17

कर्मणो ह्यपि बोद्धव्यं बोद्धव्यं च विकर्मणः ।
अकर्मणश्च बोद्धव्यं गहना कर्मणो गतिः ॥ 17 ॥

karmaṇo hyapi boddhavyaṃ
boddhavyaṃ ca vikarmaṇaḥ |
akarmaṇaśca boddhavyaṃ
gahanā karmaṇo gatiḥ ||

- ◆ karmaṇaḥ – of action; hi – indeed; api – also; boddhavyam – should be known;
- ◆ boddhavyam – should be known; ca – and; vikarmaṇaḥ – of forbidden action;
- ◆ akarmaṇaḥ – of inaction; ca – and; boddhavyam – should be known; ◆ gahanā – profound/mysterious; karmaṇaḥ – of action; gatiḥ – the path/way.

The nature of action (enjoined by the Sastras) and of wrong action (prohibited by the Sastras) and also of inaction should be known, because deep and difficult to understand is the path of action.

049. Chapter 4 Verse 18

VERSE 4.18

कर्मण्यकर्म यः पश्येदकर्मणि च कर्म यः ।
स बुद्धिमान्मनुष्येषु स युक्तः कृत्स्नकर्मकृत् ॥ 18 ॥

karmaṇyakarma yaḥ paśyed
akarmaṇi ca karma yaḥ |
sa buddhimānmanuṣyeṣu
sa yuktaḥ kṛtsnakarmakṛt ||

◆ karmaṇi – in action; akarma – inaction; yaḥ – who; paśyet – sees; ◆ akarmaṇi – in inaction; ca – and; karma – action; yaḥ – who; ◆ saḥ – he; buddhimān – wise; manuṣyeṣu – among men; ◆ saḥ – he; yuktaḥ – a Yogi; kṛtsna-karma-kṛt – a doer of all actions

Who sees action in inaction and inaction in action, he is the wise man, the yogi, the doer of all actions among men.

050. Chapter 4 Verse 19

VERSE 4.19

यस्य सर्वे समारम्भाः कामसङ्कल्पवर्जिताः ।
ज्ञानाग्निदग्धकर्माणं तमाहुः पण्डितं बुधाः ॥ 19 ॥

yasya sarve samārambhāḥ
kāmasaṅkalpavarjitāḥ |
jñānāgnidagdhakarmāṇam
tamāhuḥ paṇḍitaṁ budhāḥ ||

◆ yasya – whose; sarve – all; samārambhāḥ – undertakings; ◆ kāma-saṅkalpa – desire and purpose/will; varjitāḥ – free from; ◆ jñāna-agni – by the fire of knowledge; dagdha – burnt; karmāṇam – actions; ◆ tam – him; āhuḥ – call; paṇḍitam – a sage; budhāḥ – the wise.

He whose undertakings are all free from desire and volition, whose actions are burnt in the fire of knowledge, is called a sage by the wise.

051. Chapter 4 Verses 20-22

VERSE 4.20

त्यक्त्वा कर्मफलासङ्गं नित्यतृप्तो निराश्रयः ।
कर्मण्यभिप्रवृत्तोऽपि नैव किञ्चित्करोति सः ॥ 20 ॥

tyaktvā karmaphalāsaṅgam
nityatr̥pto nirāśrayaḥ |
karmaṇyabhipravṛtto'pi
naiva kiñcitkaroti saḥ ||

◆ tyaktvā – having given up; karma-phala-āsaṅgam – attachment to the fruit of action; ◆ nitya-tr̥ptaḥ – ever satisfied; nirāśrayaḥ – depending on nothing/ refuge-less; ◆ karmaṇi – in action; abhipravṛttaḥ – engaged; api – even; ◆ na – not; eva – certainly; kiñcit – anything; karoti – does; saḥ – he.

He who has given up attachment to the fruits of work, who is ever content, who does not depend upon anything, though engaged in action does not verily do anything.

VERSE 4.21

निराशीर्यतचित्तात्मा त्यक्तसर्वपरिग्रहः ।
शरीरं केवलं कर्म कुर्वन्नाप्नोति किल्बिषम् ॥ 21 ॥

nirāśīryatacittātmā
tyaktasarvaparigrahaḥ |
śārīraṃ kevalaṃ karma
kurvannāpnoti kilbiṣam ||

◆ nirāśīḥ – free from hope/expectation; yata-citta-ātmā – with mind and self controlled; ◆ tyakta-sarva-parigrahaḥ – having abandoned all possessions; ◆ śārīram – relating to the body; kevalam – only; karma – action; ◆ kurvan – performing; na āpnoti – does not incur; kilbiṣam – sin.

He who is free from hope, who is self-controlled, who has abandoned all possessions, though working merely with the body, does not incur sin.

VERSE 4.22

यदृच्छालाभसन्तुष्टो द्वन्द्वातीतो विमत्सरः ।
समः सिद्धावसिद्धौ च कृत्वापि न निबध्यते ॥ 22 ॥

yadṛcchālābhasantuṣṭo
dvandvātīto vimatsaraḥ |
samaḥ siddhāvasiddhau ca
kṛtvāpi na nibadhyate ||

◆ yadṛcchā-lābha-santuṣṭaḥ – satisfied with whatever comes by chance; ◆
dvandva-atītaḥ – beyond the pairs of opposites (dualities); vimatsaraḥ – free
from envy; ◆ samaḥ – equal/steady; siddhau-asiddhau – in success and failure;
ca – and; ◆ kṛtvā api – even having acted; na nibadhyate – is not bound.

**Content with whatsoever he gets without efforts, free from
the pairs of opposites, free from malice, balanced in success
and failure, though acting, he is not bound.**

052. Chapter 4 Verses 23-24

VERSE 4.23

गतसङ्गस्य मुक्तस्य ज्ञानावस्थितचेतसः ।
यज्ञायाचरतः कर्म समग्रं प्रविलीयते ॥ 23 ॥

gataśaṅgasya muktasya
jñānāvasthitacetasaḥ |
yajñāyācarataḥ karma
samagraṁ pravilīyate ||

◆ gata-śaṅgasya – of one who is devoid of attachment; muktasya – of the liberated; ◆ jñāna-avasthita-cetasaḥ – whose mind is established in knowledge; ◆ yajñāya – for the sake of sacrifice; ācarataḥ – of one who performs; karma – action; ◆ samagram – entirely; pravilīyate – is dissolved/melts away.

Of the man who is devoid of attachment, who is liberated, whose mind is established in knowledge, the whole action performed in the spirit of sacrifice is dissolved.

VERSE 4.24

ब्रह्मार्पणं ब्रह्म हविर्ब्रह्माग्नौ ब्रह्मणा हुतम् ।
ब्रह्मैव तेन गन्तव्यं ब्रह्मकर्मसमाधिना ॥ 24 ॥

brahmārpaṇaṃ brahma havir
brahmāgnau brahmaṇā hutam |
brahmaiva tena gantavyaṃ
brahmakarmasamādhinā ||

◆ brahma-arpaṇam – the act of offering is Brahman; brahma – Brahman; haviḥ – the oblation/clarified butter; ◆ brahma-agnau – in the fire of Brahman; brahmaṇā – by Brahman; hutam – is offered; ◆ brahma eva – Brahman only; tena – by him; gantavyam – to be reached; ◆ brahma-karma-samādhinā – who is absorbed in Brahman as action.

The oblation is Brahman, the offerings are Brahman, the sacrifice is Brahman, and by absorption in action which is Brahman, Brahman alone shall be reached by him (by the sacrifice).

053. Chapter 4 Verses 25-28

VERSE 4.25

दैवमेवापरे यज्ञं योगिनः पर्युपासते ।
ब्रह्माग्नावपरे यज्ञं यज्ञेनैवोपजुह्वति ॥ 25 ॥

daivamevāpare yajñam
yoginaḥ paryupāsate |
brahmāgnāvapare yajñam
yajñenaivopajuhvati ||

◆ daivam – pertaining to the gods; eva – only; apare – some; yajñam – sacrifice;
◆ yoginaḥ – Yogis; paryupāsate – perform; ◆ brahma-agnau – in the fire of Brahman; apare – others; yajñam – sacrifice; ◆ yajñena – by sacrifice; eva – only; upajuhvati – offer.

Some yogis perform sacrifice pertaining to the Gods only, others by the union of the self (jiva) with Brahman, offer the Jiva as sacrifice in the fire of Brahman.

VERSE 4.26

श्रोत्रादीनीन्द्रियाण्यन्ये संयमाग्निषु जुह्वति ।
शब्दादीन्विषयानन्य इन्द्रियाग्निषु जुह्वति ॥ 26 ॥

śrotrādīnīndriyāṇyanye
saṁyamāgniṣu juhvati |
śabdādīnviṣayānanya
indriyāgniṣu juhvati ||

◆ śrotra-ādīni – hearing and other; indriyāṇi – senses; anye – others; ◆
saṁyama-agniṣu – in the fires of restraint; juhvati – offer; ◆ śabda-ādīn – sound
and other; viṣayān – objects; anye – others; ◆ indriya-agniṣu – in the fires of the
senses; juhvati – offer.

**Others sacrifice the senses like the organ of hearing etc., in
the fires of sense – restraint, and some others sacrifice the
sense-objects like sound etc., in the fire of the senses.**

VERSE 4.27

सर्वाणीन्द्रियकर्माणि प्राणकर्माणि चापरे ।
आत्मसंयमयोगाग्नौ जुह्वति ज्ञानदीपिते ॥ 27 ॥

sarvāṇīndriyakarmāṇi
prāṇakarmāṇi cāpare |
ātmasaṁyamayogāgnau
juhvati jñānadīpite ||

◆ sarvāṇi – all; indriya-karmāṇi – functions of the senses; ◆ prāṇa-karmāṇi – functions of the vital breaths; ca – and; apare – others; ◆ ātma-saṁyama-yoga-agnau – in the fire of the Yoga of self-restraint; ◆ juhvati – offer; jñāna-dīpite – kindled by knowledge.

Others sacrifice all the functions of the senses and the functions of the vital energy (prana) in the fire of the yoga of self-control, illumined by Knowledge.

VERSE 4.28

द्रव्ययज्ञास्तपोयज्ञा योगयज्ञास्तथापरे ।
स्वाध्यायज्ञानयज्ञाश्च यतयः संशितव्रताः ॥ 28 ॥

dravyayajñāstapoyajñā
yogayajñāstathāpare |
svādhyāyajñānāyajñāśca
yatayaḥ saṁśitavratāḥ ||

◆ dravya-yajñāḥ – sacrifice of wealth/possessions; tapaḥ-yajñāḥ – sacrifice of austerity; ◆ yoga-yajñāḥ – sacrifice of Yoga; tathā – and; apare – others; ◆ svādhyāya-jñāna-yajñāḥ – sacrifice of study and knowledge; ca – and; ◆ yatayaḥ – seekers/ascetics; saṁśita-vratāḥ – of rigid vows.

Others offer wealth, austerity and Yoga as sacrifice and again others, the ascetics of rigid vows offer study and knowledge as sacrifice.

054. Chapter 4 Verses 29-30

VERSE 4.29

अपाने जुह्वति प्राणं प्राणेऽपानं तथापरे ।
प्राणापानगती रुद्ध्वा प्राणायामपरायणाः ॥ 29 ॥

apāne juhvati prāṇam
prāṇe'pānam tathāpare |
prāṇāpānagatī ruddhvā
prāṇāyāmaparāyaṇāḥ ||

◆ apāne – in the out-going breath; juhvati – offer; prāṇam – the in-coming breath; ◆ prāṇe – in the in-coming breath; apānam – the out-going breath; tathā – and; apare – others; ◆ prāṇa-apāna-gatī – courses of in-coming and out-going breaths; ruddhvā – stopping; ◆ prāṇāyāma-parāyaṇāḥ – devoted to breath-control (Pranayama).

Some, again, constantly practising the regulation of prāna, offer the oblation of prāna into apāna, and apāna into prāna, or stop the passage of both prāna and apāna. Yet others, restricting their food, offer their prānas in the prānas.

VERSE 4.30

अपरे नियताहाराः प्राणान्प्राणेषु जुह्वति ।
सर्वेऽप्येते यज्ञविदो यज्ञक्षपितकल्मषाः ॥ 30 ॥

apare niyatāhārāḥ
prāṇānprāṇeṣu juhvati |
sarve'pyete yajñavido
yajñakṣapitakalmaṣāḥ ||

◆ apare – others; niyata-āhārāḥ – restricting food; ◆ prāṇān – vital breaths; prāṇeṣu – in vital breaths; juhvati – offer; ◆ sarve – all; api – even; ete – these; yajña-vidaḥ – knowers of sacrifice; ◆ yajña-kṣapita-kalmaṣāḥ – whose sins are destroyed by sacrifice.

Others of regulated food, sacrifice the life – breaths in the life – breaths; all these also are are knowers of sacrifice whose sins are destroyed by sacrifice.

055. Chapter 4 Verses 31-32

VERSE 4.31

यज्ञशिष्टामृतभुजो यान्ति ब्रह्म सनातनम् ।
नायं लोकोऽस्त्ययज्ञस्य कुतोऽन्यः कुरुसत्तम ॥ 31 ॥

yajñaśiṣṭāmṛtabhujo
yānti brahma sanātanam |
nāyaṃ loko'styayajñasya
kuto'nyaḥ kurusattama ||

◆ yajña-śiṣṭa – remnants of sacrifice; amṛta-bhujah – eaters of the nectar; ◆
yānti – go to; brahma – Brahman; sanātanam – eternal; ◆ na – not; ayam – this;
lokaḥ – world; asti – is; ayajñasya – for the non-sacrificer; ◆ kutaḥ – how; anyaḥ
– the other (world); kuru-sattama – O best of the Kurus.

**Those who eat the remnants of sacrifice which is nectar, go
to eternal Brahman; to the non- sacrificer, even this world is
not, how then can he get a higher world?**

VERSE 4.32

एवं बहुविधा यज्ञा वितता ब्रह्मणो मुखे ।
कर्मजान्विद्धि तान्सर्वानेवं ज्ञात्वा विमोक्षयसे ॥ 32 ॥

- ◆ evaṃ bahuvidhā yajñā
- ◆ vitatā brahmaṇo mukhe |
- ◆ karmajānviddhi tānsarvānevaṃ
- ◆ jñātvā vimokṣyase ||

evam – thus; bahu-vidhāḥ – various types; yajñāḥ – sacrifices; vitatāḥ – are spread out/detailed; brahmaṇaḥ mukhe – in the Vedas (mouth of Brahman); karma-jān – born of action; viddhi – know; tān – them; sarvān – all; evam – thus; jñātvā – knowing; vimokṣyase – you shall be liberated.

**Thus various forms of sacrifice are spread out in the Vedas;
know them all to be born of action; thus knowing you shall
be liberated.**

056. Chapter 4 Verses 33-34

VERSE 4.33

श्रेयान्द्रव्यमयाद्यज्ञाज्ज्ञानयज्ञः परन्तप ।
सर्वं कर्माखिलं पार्थ ज्ञाने परिसमाप्यते ॥ 33 ॥

śreyāndravyamayādyajñāḥ
jñānayajñaḥ parantapa |
sarvaṁ karmākhilaṁ pārtha
jñāne parisamāpyate ||

◆ śreyān – superior; dravya-mayāt – consisting of material possessions; yajñāt – than sacrifice; ◆ jñāna-yajñaḥ – sacrifice of knowledge; parantapa – O scorcher of foes; ◆ sarvaṁ – all; karma – action; akhilaṁ – in its entirety; pārtha – O Partha; ◆ jñāne – in knowledge; parisamāpyate – culminates.

O scorcher of foes! Knowledge-sacrifice is superior to sacrifice performed with objects. All actions, O Arjuna, in their entirety, culminate in Knowledge.

VERSE 4.34

तद्विद्धि प्रणिपातेन परिप्रश्नेन सेवया ।
उपदेक्ष्यन्ति ते ज्ञानं ज्ञानिनस्तत्त्वदर्शिनः ॥ 34 ॥

tadviddhi praṇipātena
paripraśnena sevayā |
upadekṣyanti te jñānam
jñāninastattvadarśinaḥ ||

◆ tat – that (knowledge); viddhi – know/learn; praṇipātena – by prostrating; ◆
paripraśnena – by inquiry; sevayā – by service; ◆ upadekṣyanti – will instruct;
te – you; jñānam – in knowledge; ◆ jñāninaḥ – the wise; tattva-darśinaḥ – the
seers of Truth.

**Know that (Knowledge) by long prostration, question, and
service (to the master). The sages who have realised the
truth will instruct you in that knowledge.**

057. Chapter 4 Verses 35-37

VERSE 4.35

यज्ज्ञात्वा न पुनर्मोहमेवं यास्यसि पाण्डव ।
येन भूतान्यशेषेण द्रक्ष्यस्यात्मन्यथो मयि ॥ 35 ॥

yajjñātvā na punarmoham
evam yāsyasi pāṇḍava |
yena bhūtānyaśeṣeṇa
drakṣyasyātmanyatho mayi ||

◆ yat – which; jñātvā – knowing; na – not; punaḥ – again; moham – to delusion;
◆ evam – thus; yāsyasi – you shall go; pāṇḍava – O Pandava; ◆ yena – by which;
bhūtāni – living beings; aśeṣeṇa – all; ◆ drakṣyasi – you will see; ātmani – in the
Self; atha u – and also; mayi – in Me.

**O Arjuna! Having obtained this knowledge, you will not thus
be deluded again and by this Knowledge, you will see all
beings in your Self and also in Me.**

VERSE 4.36

अपि चेदसि पापेभ्यः सर्वेभ्यः पापकृत्तमः ।
सर्वं ज्ञानप्लवेनैव वृजिनं सन्तरिष्यसि ॥ 36 ॥

api cedasi pāpebhyaḥ
sarvebhyaḥ pāpakṛttamaḥ |
sarvaṁ jñānaplavenaiva
vṛjinam santariṣyasi ||

◆ api cet – even if; asi – you are; pāpebhyaḥ – of sinners; ◆ sarvebhyaḥ – of all;
pāpa-kṛt-tamaḥ – the most sinful; ◆ sarvaṁ – all; jñāna-plavena – by the boat of
knowledge; eva – alone; ◆ vṛjinam – sin/misery; santariṣyasi – you shall cross.

**Even if you are the most sinful of all sinners you shall cross
all sin by the raft of Knowledge.**

VERSE 4.37

यथैधांसि समिद्धोऽग्निर्भस्मसात्कुरुतेऽर्जुन ।
ज्ञानाग्निः सर्वकर्माणि भस्मसात्कुरुते तथा ॥ 37 ॥

yathaidhāṃsi samiddho'gnir
bhasmasātkurute'rjuna |
jñānāgniḥ sarvakarmāṇi
bhasmasātkurute tathā ||

◆ yathā – as; edhāṃsi – fuel/logs; samiddhaḥ – blazing; agniḥ – fire; ◆
bhasmasāt – to ashes; kurute – turns; arjuna – O Arjuna; ◆ jñāna-agniḥ – the fire
of knowledge; sarva-karmāṇi – all actions (karma); ◆ bhasmasāt – to ashes;
kurute – turns; tathā – so.

**O Arjuna! Just as blazing fire reduces wood to ashes, even so,
the fire of, Knowledge destroys all actions.**

058. Chapter 4 Verses 38-41

VERSE 4.38

न हि ज्ञानेन सदृशं पवित्रमिह विद्यते ।
तत्स्वयं योगसंसिद्धः कालेनात्मनि विन्दति ॥ 38 ॥

na hi jñānena sadṛśam
pavitramiha vidyate |
tatsvayaṃ yogasaṃsiddhaḥ
kālenātmani vindati ||

◆ na hi – not indeed; jñānena – to knowledge; sadṛśam – like/equal; ◆ pavitram – purifier; iha – here (in this world); vidyate – exists; ◆ tat – that; svayam – himself; yoga-saṃsiddhaḥ – one perfected in Yoga; ◆ kālena – in time; ātmani – in the Self; vindati – finds/attains.

**Indeed there is nothing so pure as Knowledge in this world.
He who is perfected in Nishkama Karma finds that wisdom
by himself in Atma in due season.**

VERSE 4.39

श्रद्धावान् लभते ज्ञानं तत्परः संयतेन्द्रियः ।
ज्ञानं लब्ध्वा परां शान्तिमचिरेणाधिगच्छति ॥ ३९ ॥

śraddhāvāṁllabhate jñānaṁ
tatparaḥ saṁyatendriyaḥ |
jñānaṁ labdhvā parāṁ śāntim
acireṇādhigacchati ||

◆ śraddhāvān – the man of faith; labhate – obtains; jñānam – knowledge; ◆ tatparaḥ – devoted to it; saṁyata-indriyaḥ – who has subdued the senses; ◆ jñānam – knowledge; labdhvā – having obtained; parāṁ – supreme; śāntim – peace; ◆ acireṇa – quickly; adhigacchati – attains.

**The man of faith, having Knowledge as his supreme goal
having controlled the senses, obtains knowledge of Atma,
and having obtained that enjoys everlasting peace.**

VERSE 4.40

अज्ञश्चाश्रद्धधानश्च संशयात्मा विनश्यति ।
नायं लोको ऽस्ति न परो न सुखं संशयात्मनः ॥ 40 ॥

ajñāścāśraddadhānaśca
saṁśayaātmā vinaśyati |
nāyaṁ loko'styaparo
na sukhaṁ saṁśayaātmanaḥ ||

◆ ajñāḥ – the ignorant; ca – and; āśraddadhānaḥ – the faithless; ca – and; ◆
saṁśaya-ātmā – the doubting soul; vinaśyati – goes to ruin; ◆ na – not; ayam –
this; lokaḥ – world; asti – is; na paraḥ – nor the next; ◆ na sukham – nor
happiness; saṁśaya-ātmanaḥ – for the doubting soul

**But the ignorant man, the faithless man, the doubting man
goes to destruction. For the doubting self, there is no
happiness either in this world or the next.**

VERSE 4.41

योगसंन्यस्तकर्माणं ज्ञानसञ्छिन्नसंशयम् ।
आत्मवन्तं न कर्माणि निबध्नन्ति धनञ्जय ॥ 41 ॥

yogasamnyastakarmāṇam
jñānachinnasaṁśayam |
ātmavantam na karmāṇi
nibadnanti dhanañjaya ||

◆ yoga-samnyasta-karmāṇam – who has renounced actions through Yoga; ◆
jñāna-chinna-saṁśayam – whose doubts are rent asunder by knowledge; ◆
ātmavantam – possessed of the Self/self-possession; na – not; karmāṇi – actions;
◆ nibadnanti – bind; dhanañjaya – O Dhananjaya (Arjuna).

O Arjuna! Actions do not bind the man who has surrendered the fruits of karma by yoga, whose doubts are cleared by Knowledge, and who is firmly established in the Self.

059. Chapter 4 Verse 42 + Ch 4 Summary

VERSE 4.42

तस्मादज्ञानसम्भूतं हृत्स्थं ज्ञानासिनात्मनः ।
छित्त्वैनं संशयं योगमातिष्ठोत्तिष्ठ भारत ॥ 42 ॥

tasmādajñānasambhūtaṃ
hṛtsthaṃ jñānāsinātmanah |
chittvainaṃ saṃśayaṃ yogam
ātiṣṭhottiṣṭha bhārata ||

◆ tasmāt – therefore; ajñāna-sambhūtaṃ – born of ignorance; ◆ hṛt-stham – dwelling in the heart; jñāna-asinā – by the sword of knowledge; ātmanah – of the self; ◆ chittvā – having slashed/cut; enam – this; saṃśayaṃ – doubt; yogam – Yoga; ◆ ātiṣṭha – take refuge in; uttiṣṭha – arise; bhārata – O Bharata.

Therefore, with the sword of Knowledge cut asunder the doubt born of ignorance about the Self, dwelling in the heart and take refuge in Yoga. Arise, O Arjuna!